

Indian Important FESTIVALS & FAIRS

Major Religious Festivals & Cultural Fairs of India

FESTIVALS



Religious Festivals



Regional Festivals



Agricultural Festivals



New Year Festivals



Seasonal Festivals

FAIRS



Religious Fairs



Cattle Fairs



Cultural & Tribal Fairs



Trade & Handicraft Fairs



Local & Regional Fairs



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Major Religious Festivals of India (Part 1)

1

Diwali

Location : Across India

Significance : Victory of good over evil.



2

Holi

Location : Across India

Significance : Celebration of colours; symbolises the victory of good over evil.



3

Durga Puja

Location : West Bengal

Significance : Worship of Goddess Durga; victory of good over Mahishasura.



4

Rath Yatra

Location : Puri, Odisha

Significance : Associated with Lord Jagannath.



5

Ganesh Chaturthi

Location : Maharashtra

Significance : Worship of Lord Ganesha.



6

Janmashtami

Location : Mathura and Vrindavan (Uttar Pradesh)

Significance : Birth of Lord Krishna.



7

Ram Navami

Location : Ayodhya (Uttar Pradesh)

Significance : Birth of Lord Rama.



8

Maha Shivaratri

Location : Across India

Significance : Worship of Lord Shiva.



9

Chhath Puja

Location : Bihar and eastern Uttar Pradesh

Significance : Worship of Sun God (Surya).



10

Onam

Location : Kerala

Significance : Associated with the legend of King Mahabali.





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Harvest & New Year Festivals (Part 2)

1

Baisakhi



Location : Punjab



Significance : Harvest of rabi crops; Sikh new year.



2

Pongal



Location : Tamil Nadu



Significance : Harvest festival.



3

Makar Sankranti



Location : Across India



Significance : Marks the sun's transition into Capricorn (Makara).



4

Lohri



Location : Punjab and adjoining regions



Significance : Marks the end of winter and harvest season.



5

Bihu



Location : Assam



Significance : Marks the agricultural cycle (3 forms – Rongali, Kongali, Bhogali).



6

Nuakhai



Location : Odisha



Significance : Welcome of new rice of the season.



7

Ugadi



Location : Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka



Significance : New year festival.



8

Gudi Padwa



Location : Maharashtra



Significance : Marathi new year.



9

Vishu



Location : Kerala



Significance : New year festival.



10

Puthandu



Location : Tamil Nadu



Significance : Tamil new year.





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Tribal & North-Eastern Festivals of India

1 Hornbill Festival

Location : Nagaland

Significance : Showcases the culture of Naga tribes.



2 Chapchar Kut

Location : Mizoram

Significance : Post-harvest festival.



3 Wangala Festival

Location : Meghalaya

Significance : Harvest festival of the Garo community.



4 Nongkrem Festival

Location : Meghalaya

Significance : Associated with the Khasi community (worship of Ka Blei).



5 Sekrenyi Festival

Location : Nagaland

Significance : Festival of the Angami Naga tribe (purification).



6 Yaoshang

Location : Manipur

Significance : Associated with the Meitei community (similar to Holi).



7 Sangai Festival

Location : Manipur

Significance : Promotes the state animal Sangai (brow-antlered deer) and Manipuri culture.



8 Losar

Location : Ladakh (UT) and Himalayan regions

Significance : Tibetan Buddhist New Year.



9 Mopin Festival

Location : Arunachal Pradesh

Significance : Harvest and prosperity festival of the Galo community.



10 Lui-Ngai-Ni

Location : Nagaland

Significance : Seed-sowing festival of the Naga tribes.





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Major Religious Fairs & Pilgrimages of India

1

Kumbh Mela



Location : Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain and Nashik.



Significance : World's largest religious gathering of Hindus.



2

Gangasagar Mela



Location : Sagar Island, West Bengal.



Significance : Held on the occasion of Makar Sankranti.



3

Pushkar Fair



Location : Pushkar, Rajasthan.



Significance : Famous religious fair associated with Lord Brahma.



4

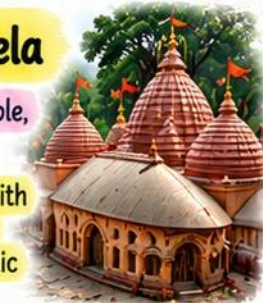
Ambubachi Mela



Location : Kamakhya Temple, Assam.



Significance : Associated with the annual menstruation of Goddess Kamakhya (symbolic fertility).



5

Urs



Location : Ajmer Sharif, Rajasthan.



Significance : Commemorates the death anniversary of Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti.



6

Hemis Festival



Location : Hemis Monastery, Ladakh.



Significance : Celebrates the birth anniversary of Guru Padmasambhava.



7

Sabarimala Pilgrimage



Location : Sabarimala, Kerala.



Significance : Dedicated to Lord Ayyappa.



8

Pandharpur Wari



Location : Pandharpur, Maharashtra.



Significance : Associated with the worship of Lord Vithoba.



9

Nanda Devi Raj Jat



Location : Uttarakhand.



Significance : Important religious pilgrimage associated with Goddess Nanda Devi.



10

Sonepur Mela



Location : Sonepur, Bihar.



Significance : Major fair for cattle trading, held on the confluence of Gandak and Ganga rivers.





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Famous Fairs of India (Part 1)

1 Pushkar Fair

Location : Pushkar, Rajasthan.

Significance : Religious fair associated with Lord Brahma.



2 Sonepur Mela

Location : Sonepur, Bihar.

Significance : Famous for cattle trading; held at the confluence of Gandak and Ganga rivers.



3 Nagaur Cattle Fair

Location : Nagaur, Rajasthan.

Significance : Famous for cattle trading.



4 Tarnetar Fair

Location : Tarnetar, Gujarat.

Significance : Known for traditional matchmaking and folk culture.



5 Bateshwar Fair

Location : Bateshwar, Uttar Pradesh.

Significance : Associated with Lord Shiva.



6 Kolayat Fair

Location : Kolayat, Rajasthan.

Significance : Religious fair held at Kolayat Lake; associated with Kapil Muni.



7 Chandrabhaga Fair

Location : Chandrabhaga, Odisha.

Significance : Associated with the worship of Sun God.



8 Minjar Fair

Location : Chamba, Himachal Pradesh.

Significance : Celebrated to pray for a good harvest and to avert natural disasters.



9 Lavi Fair

Location : Rampur, Himachal Pradesh.

Significance : Traditional trade fair; famous for wool, shawls and local products.



10 Bhagoria Haat

Location : Jhabua, Alirajpur (Madhya Pradesh).

Significance : Tribal fair of the Bhil and Bhilala communities; known for its unique tradition of selecting life partners.





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Famous Fairs of India (Part 2)

1

Surajkund International Crafts Mela



Location : Surajkund,
Haryana.



Significance : Famous
for handicrafts, handlooms
and traditional art.



2

Kullu Dussehra



Location : Kullu,
Himachal Pradesh.



Significance : Celebrated
for a week after Vijayadashami
with the participation of local
deities.



3

Khajuraho Dance Festival



Location : Khajuraho,
Madhya Pradesh.



Significance : Showcases
classical dance forms at
the backdrop of ancient
temples.



4

Konark Dance Festival



Location : Konark,
Odisha.



Significance : Promotes
classical dance forms at
the Konark Sun Temple.



5

Thrissur Pooram



Location : Thrissur,
Kerala.



Significance : Famous
for grand temple procession
with decorated elephants.



6

Goa Carnival



Location : Goa.



Significance : Known for
vibrant street parades,
music, dance and floats.



7

Rann Utsav



Location : Kutch,
Gujarat.



Significance : Celebrates
the culture, crafts and
traditions of the region at
the Great Rann of Kutch.



8

Jaisalmer Desert Festival



Location : Jaisalmer,
Rajasthan.



Significance : Showcases
desert culture, folk music
and traditional performances.



9

Ziro Festival of Music



Location : Ziro Valley,
Arunachal Pradesh.



Significance : Promotes
independent music and
showcases local Apatani
tribal culture.



10

Tawang Festival



Location : Tawang,
Arunachal Pradesh.



Significance : Showcases
the rich Monpa culture and
Buddhist traditions.





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State-wise Important Festivals (Part 1)

1

Onam

Location : Kerala

Significance : Associated with the legend of King Mahabali.



2

Baisakhi

Location : Punjab

Significance : Marks the harvest season and Sikh New Year.



3

Chhath Puja

Location : Bihar

Significance : Worship of the Sun God.



4

Gangaur

Location : Rajasthan

Significance : Worship of Goddess Gauri for marital happiness.



5

Teej

Location : Rajasthan

Significance : Dedicated to Goddess Parvati; celebrated for marital bliss.



6

Pongal

Location : Tamil Nadu

Significance : Harvest festival.



7

Bihu

Location : Assam

Significance : Marks the agricultural cycle of Assam.

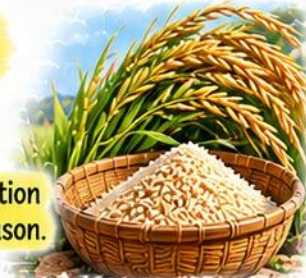


8

Nuakhai

Location : Odisha

Significance : Celebration of new rice of the season.



9

Ugadi

Location : Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka

Significance : New year festival.



10

Gudi Padwa

Location : Maharashtra

Significance : Marks the Marathi New Year.





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State-wise Important Festivals (Part 2)

1

Rath Yatra



Location : Puri, Odisha.



Significance : Chariot festival of Lord Jagannath.



2

Hemis Fair



Location : Ladakh.



Significance : Celebrates the birth anniversary of Guru Padmasambhava.



3

Losar



Location : Ladakh.



Significance : Tibetan Buddhist New Year.



4

Mopin



Location : Arunachal Pradesh.



Significance : Agricultural festival of the Galo community.



5

Hornbill Festival



Location : Nagaland.



Significance : Showcases the culture of Naga tribes.



6

Wangala



Location : Meghalaya.



Significance : Harvest festival of the Garo community.



7

Nongkrem



Location : Meghalaya.



Significance : Associated with the Khasi community (worship of Ka Blei).



8

Chapchar Kut



Location : Mizoram.



Significance : Post-harvest festival.



9

Sekrenyi



Location : Nagaland.



Significance : Purification festival of the Angami Naga tribe.



10

Lui-Ngai-Ni



Location : Nagaland.



Significance : Seed-sowing festival of the Naga tribes.





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